

A:1

Aria in F

BWV Anh. II 131

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J. C. Bach
(1735–82)

The musical score for 'Aria in F' by J.C. Bach, BWV Anh. II 131, is presented in three systems. The first system (measures 1-5) begins with a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = c.63$ and a dynamic of *mf*. It features a treble staff with a trill in measure 3 and a bass staff with a triplet in measure 3. The second system (measures 6-10) starts with a dynamic of *mp* and includes a repeat sign in measure 7. The third system (measures 11-14) begins with a dynamic of *f* and ends with a double bar line. The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, staccato marks (v), and fingerings (1-5).

This charming little piece was written by Bach's youngest son Johann Christian when he was little more than 10 years old. He wrote it out in the *Clavierbüchlein*, or Little Keyboard Book, that Bach dedicated to his wife Anna Magdalena in 1725. This manuscript album, filled up gradually over the next 20 years or so, gives a vivid picture of domestic music-making in the Bach family home during that period.

The wedges in b. 4 etc. denote staccato and imply a light accent. Minims so marked might be shortened to half their value. The dynamics are editorial suggestions only, as are the slurs and staccatos, except for the right-hand wedges in bb. 12 and 14.

Source: Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin, Preußischer Kulturbesitz, Mus.ms.Bach P225

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Adapted from J. S. Bach et al.: *The Anna Magdalena Bach Book of 1725*, edited by Richard Jones (ABRSM)